it could use the Islamic block as global leverage to achieve its long held desire to annex all of Kashmir; next, acquire arms and funds to strengthen itself against India and Afghanistan; and finally, threaten Moscow and entertain China.

President Karmal later disclosed that the unfaithful Amin had been killed because he had been working with the CIA and trying to nullify Afghanistan's progressive ideas by planning a bloody coup together with Gulbuddin Hekmatyar, leader of the Hizb-e-Islami, an ISI sponsored terror group that wanted to establish sharia rule in Afghanistan.

On 12 January 1980, Karmal abolished the KAM and set up a new intelligence service called KHAD that aimed to protect democratic freedoms, national independence and sovereignty and the interests of revolution, the people and the state, and to neutralise plots hatched by external enemies.

In an editorial dated 2 January 1980, Kabul Times wrote that the US president James Carter had wept for Amin despite the fact that he had killed President Taraki and other opponents. The editorial also said that the US criticised the Soviet Union for sending troops to Afghanistan, although the US itself had violated international law and the principles of the UN charter no less than forty-eight times since 1950 by landing troops in several countries.

For those who loved their spycraft, Kabul was the best place to be in early 1980. In February, residents of the city secretly organised an unarmed resistance by distributing 'sha-banams' (night letters) against the Soviet military presence in Afghanistan. Days later they loudly chanted Allah-hu-Akbar' from their rooftops. The Karmal government retaliated with a massive show of force. For two days, four MIG fighter planes